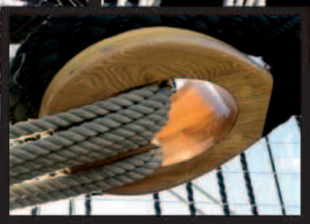


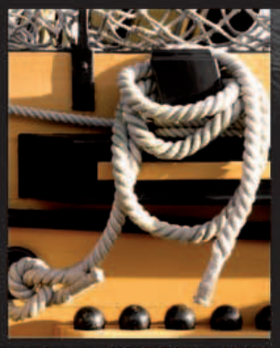
**Main mast**
*Victory*'s main mast reaches 220 ft (67 m) above sea level. Halfway up is a platform; this was used by musketeers in battle, and by the crew when access to sails was needed.



**Standing rigging**
The ropes which hold the masts in place are known as standing rigging. Of these, "shrouds" are tied to the sides of the ship, forming a ladder up the masts.



**Running rigging**
The ropes which raise, lower, and manipulate sails are known as running rigging.



**Rigging**
A total of 26 miles (42 km) of rope (or "cordage") was used to rig *Victory*, along with 768 blocks, or pulleys. All sailors learned how to mend rope, which easily frayed at the ends.





**Heavy anchor and gun ports**
*Victory* had seven anchors, the heaviest weighing more than 4.5 tons. Raising the latter required the effort of 144 men turning two interlinked capstans. The anchor was hung above the upper gun deck.



**Double wheel and binnacle**
Located under the poop deck, the double wheel was operated by four men in calm weather, and up to eight men in a storm. The binnacle in front of the wheel contains two compasses and a lantern for taking readings at night. The copper flue on top of the binnacle allowed smoke from the lantern to escape, keeping the binnacle clean.





**Skylight**
A skylight (here covered) stood in the middle of the poop deck, allowing light to enter the great cabin below.

**Carronade**
*Victory* had two carronades mounted on her forecastle. They were lethal at close range, as shown by their contribution to the mauling of the French ship *Bucentaure* at Trafalgar.





**Belfry**
The bell in the belfry was rung every half hour. Two sandglasses kept the time, one lasting half an hour, one lasting four hours. Both were set at the beginning of each four-hour watch, at which the bell was rung eight times.